

1 | Make the background

STEP 1 OF 4

DO

Use oil pastels to build bands of plum, coral, orange and yellow across the sky. Blend gently where the colours meet.

ADD DEPTH

Sketch a distant hill. If you want a path, make it narrow near the horizon and wider toward the bottom.

NOTICE

The lighter horizon attracts the eye. Your colours can be different from the example.



2 | Place distant trees

STEP 2 OF 4

DO

Draw small, pale trees near the horizon with pastel, or cut simple thin shapes from light paper.

THINK

Leave space between some trees so the background still shows through.

NOTICE

Smaller and lighter shapes seem farther away.



3 | Add middle trees



STEP 3 OF 4

DO

Cut several medium brown trunks. Make branches from separate narrow paper strips if that is easier.

ARRANGE FIRST

Move the pieces around before gluing. Let some overlap the distant trees without covering the whole sunset.

NOTICE

Overlapping layers begin to create a forest.

4 | Finish the foreground

STEP 4 OF 4

DO

Add one or two large, dark trunks near the edges. Glue a few leaf shapes or add pastel marks and bark texture.

CHECK

Can you see a clear foreground, middle ground and background? Change one thing to strengthen the depth.

SHARE

Point to one colour, size, or overlap choice and explain its effect.



Learning target

I can use size, overlap, colour and contrast to create depth and mood in a landscape.

Materials

White paper, oil pastels or pencil crayons, brown and black construction-paper scraps, scissors and glue. Light-coloured paper for distant trees is optional.

Time - about 70 minutes

Notice and sketch: 10 min

Blend background: 15 min

Build tree layers: 30 min

Refine and share: 15 min

Teach the visual idea

Demonstrate that near trees are bigger, darker and overlap far trees. Let students choose their own arrangement and palette.

Accessible routes

Offer pre-cut trunks or simple rectangular strips, a limited colour set, or a partner for cutting. Students can also draw a layer instead of cutting it.

Evidence of learning

Ask: "Which artistic choice makes something look closer or farther away?" Assess intentional choices and reflection, not similarity to the example.

BC Arts Education 6

Connects to purposeful use of visual elements and principles, combining materials and techniques, refining ideas, and describing artistic choices.